

activity in audio. Where sequences of game-play are short (action shooters, for instance), the music is more likely to be scored, whereas in driving games, with less demand for direct inter-activity, licensed music or longer sequences can be used.



Screenshot of Dance Dance Revolution

Game music

Music in games started in the 70s after implementation in games like “Pong” and “Spac Invaders”. In those times, vast majority of commercial music was being recorded and delivered on phonograph records and cassette tapes. As these media were expensive and impractical to implement, developers initially turned to digital music generation.

The first leap-frog in the quality and presence of game music in home-consoles occurred with the NES. And from then on, till date, the game music evolution has witnessed a steep increasing curve.

Tools used in creating Game music

There are various tools and middle-wares, with the help of which one can create decent music for games. Some of them are cross-platform and some are platform specific.

i) Cross-platform

- ▶ **FMOD:** This tool has been used to create music for famous games like L.A.Noire, Crysis 2, Mafia 2, Starcraft II, Far Cry, Batman: Arkham Asylum. It supports multiple-platforms which include PC, MAC, Linux, Game Consoles and Portable devices. It is available for free which will allow you to use it for non-commercial purposes. To use the tool for commercial purposes, Commercial Licensing has to be done. This tool supports multiple formats which include: AIFF, ASX, DLS, FLAC, FSB, IT, M3U, MIDI, MP2, Ogg Vorbis, PLS, S3M, VAG (PS2/PS3 format), WAV, WAX, WMA, XM, XMA (only on Xbox 360), as well as raw audio data. FMOD is integrated with some famous Game Engines which include